ZIHAO YE

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University Sep 2024 – Dec 2025
M.S. in Artificial Intelligence Engineering *Pittsburgh, PA*

Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications Sep 2019 – Jun 2023
B.S. in Engineering *Beijing, China*
Joint programme with Queen Mary University of London *First Class Honours*

EXPERIENCE

Wood Wide AI, Inc. Jan 2026 – Present
Member of Technical Staff

- One of the first technical hires. Main contributor to the company's foundation model for structured and tabular data, responsible for its architecture and for taking it from early research into production.
- Led the design of the model's self-supervised pretraining methodology, implementing and experimentally validating the training objectives and curriculum strategy now used across the company's models.
- Designed and built core components of the model's encoder stack, enabling robust inference over heterogeneous and incomplete tabular data.
- Led the design and development of the platform's explanation system, which lets users ask in plain language why the model made a prediction, how groups differ, and how much to trust the answer.

Carnegie Mellon University Aug 2024 – Dec 2025
Research Assistant, Statistical Machine Learning Group *Advised by Prof. Pradeep Ravikumar*

- Proposed the first supervised feature-transformation framework for task-aware tabular representation learning, achieving state-of-the-art performance across 38 benchmark datasets. First-author submission under review at NeurIPS 2026.
- Derived a closed-form optimal transformation via kernel smoothing, theoretically explaining prior empirical approaches and establishing them as special cases of the proposed framework.

Tencent, Honor of Kings Jan 2024 – Jun 2024
Machine Learning Applied Scientist *Chengdu, China*

- Led the end-to-end development and deployment of a recommendation system serving over 100M daily active users, replacing a naive production ranking pipeline and achieving a 13% relative online CTCVR lift in A/B testing.
- Identified a revenue-optimization failure in conventional CTCVR × price ranking and proposed a power-law objective with Bayesian optimization of segment-specific parameters.
- Built the supporting production ML pipeline spanning distributed training, incremental learning, real-time feature processing, and online experimentation.

Tsinghua University Apr 2022 – Jan 2024
Research Assistant, Machine Learning Group *Advised by Prof. Jun Zhu and Prof. Jianfei Chen*

- Generalized stochastic depth to diffusion models, enabling reduced-depth denoising at inference to accelerate sampling while preserving generation quality.
- Developed a diffusion-specific execution strategy and characterized its latency and quality trade-off through extensive ablations across multiple datasets and model configurations.

Queen Mary University of London Mar 2023 – Jan 2024
Research Assistant, Computer Vision Group *Advised by Prof. Changjae Oh*

- Proposed a reference-guided image deraining framework that leverages observations from previously traversed routes to improve restoration under adverse weather.
- Designed a plug-and-play attention module compatible with existing restoration backbones. Published as first author at IEEE ICIP 2024.

Southwest Securities Aug 2021 – Jan 2022
Machine Learning Quantitative Researcher *Chongqing, China*

- Designed an end-to-end quantitative trading system spanning alpha modeling, portfolio construction, and risk management, achieving a 14% annualized return with a Sharpe ratio of 1.3.
- Developed an ensemble-based uncertainty-estimation framework using models trained on resampled data subsets, enabling confidence-aware position sizing and portfolio risk control.

PUBLICATIONS

Zihao Ye, Burak Varıcı, Johnna Sundberg, Pradeep Ravikumar. *Tabular Numeric Stretch Transformation.* Under review, NeurIPS 2026.

Zihao Ye, Jaehoon Cho, Changjae Oh. *Improving Image De-raining Models using Reference-guided Transformers.* IEEE International Conference on Image Processing (ICIP), 2024. arXiv:2408.00258.

AWARDS AND SERVICE

- Reviewer, Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR), 2026 to present.
- INI Fellowship, merit-based tuition scholarship, Carnegie Mellon University, 2024.
- S-level performance rating, the top evaluation tier and top 1% company-wide among interns, Tencent, 2024.
- Top 1% intern evaluation for quantitative research and algorithmic innovation, Southwest Securities, 2022.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and frameworks: Python, PyTorch, PySpark, SQL, TensorFlow, C/C++, CUDA, Java, MATLAB